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General Comment

The “training” of AI models on copyrighted material is a clear and present danger to the national economy, throwing countless current and future craftspersons under the bus by devaluing their skilled labor, by design, in the hopes that entire industries will be replaced with generic product, removing the capacity for those countless workers, and the countless others who rely on them financially, to make a living in the process. Without oversight and restrictions this is merely a wrecking ball, breaking everything, replacing it with inferior copies, and leaving millions without the ability to even purchase those inferior products which replaced their own output. This technology entirely relies on the painstaking work of others, proving that this pre-existing work has enormous financial value, and yet the companies behind these technologies believe that their desire to abduct this hard labor and ingenuity from America’s tradespeople - and give literally less than nothing back, since they’re actively endangering the livelihood of their victims - is of greater value. That “value” is effectively a gift to these thieves at the expense of the American economy and its workers. We are not at the mercy of these companies. They are making a product that Americans consistently demonstrate that they don’t want. Their inability to sell an inferior product without denying compensation to the creators of superior products isn’t America’s problem. The free market is speaking, and to deny that market is to deny the concept of capitalism. Any business which relies entirely on theft to survive is not actually business: it is a crime ring.

The people who claim we cannot “fall behind” on this technology, which consistently produces substandard product, are the same small number people who stand to gain financially from the downfall of America’s larger economy. Their business model is to replace superior products with inferior products that might become competent later, but only if they take the work of people who get paid for the labor, again without compensation. They do this to deliver products that the American people are actively rejecting as inferior. That the technology will get “better” is irrelevant if “better” is defined as more effective in their pursuit of not just damaging, but ending the livelihood of the American workers.